



Delaware County Council December 14th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AeTMerY3yGI
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Date: December 14, 2021

Location: Delaware County Commissioners' Courtroom, Delaware County, Indiana

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer Scott Alexander called the regular meeting of the Delaware County Council to order at [00:00:07](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Ballard, Chambers, Lassiter (noted absent later / missing), Piper, Mr. Quakenbush (virtually), Mr. Webb, Mr. Alexander, Mr. Hughes, and Ms. Smith.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Scott Alexander.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Donna [00:00:15](#).
- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was approved by roll call vote following a motion by Piper and a second by Ballard [00:01:18](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the November 23rd meeting and the executive session were approved, with Quakenbush and Chambers abstaining [00:02:31](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:43 Resolution 2021-051: Amending 2022 Budget Appropriations (Commissioners)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to take a \$1,000 commissioner salary increase and reallocate those funds to three specific employee positions. Later in the meeting, an amendment was introduced and approved to correct a line-item designation from a human resources secretary to the human resources director position, adjusting the budget line accordingly.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved as amended by roll call vote (Mr. Webb voting “no”; all other present members voting “yes”).
- **00:05:16 Resolution 2021-052: Amending 2022 Budget Appropriations (Council Salary Adjustments)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to reduce the council members’ approved \$1,000 salary increase for the following year and shift those funds into a general salary adjustments line item. Debate ensued regarding inflation, the timing and frequency of bringing previously voted items back to the agenda, and parity with other elected officials.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Webb voting “no”; all other present members voting “yes”).
- **00:18:45 November 2021 Financials Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor’s Office / Bill.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Formal approval of additional appropriations from November 2021 that were delayed due to a legal advertising publishing error (failing to meet the 10-day advance newspaper requirement).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote, passing unanimously (00:19:35).
- **00:19:58 Departmental Transfers & Financial Business**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Various department heads.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed and processed routine and necessary year-end budget transfers across multiple departments to cover deficits in FICA, overtime, and equipment:
 - **Communications:** Transfer totaling zero (00:22:51). Passed unanimously (00:23:58).

- **Circuit Court:** Transfers covering UPS units for the jail and ergonomic sit-to-stand risers/fatigue mats (00:24:14). Passed unanimously (00:29:26).
- **Data Processing:** Software maintenance to computer equipment transfer (00:29:43). Passed unanimously (00:30:13).
- **Emergency Medical Service (EMS):** Staff position and paramedic/EMT line adjustments (00:30:29). Passed unanimously (00:31:31).
- **Public Defender:** Attorney fees and transcript line adjustments (00:31:48). Passed unanimously (00:32:21).
- **Sheriff (Education Incentives):** Overtime to education incentives transfer (00:32:35). Passed unanimously (00:33:52).
- **Jail:** Clothing allowance and overtime adjustments to close out the year (00:34:07). Passed unanimously (00:36:26).
- **Highway:** Truck driver line adjustment (00:36:44). Passed unanimously (00:37:05).
- **Community Corrections (Project Income):** FICA/PERF to client monitoring transfer (00:37:20). Passed unanimously (00:38:11).
- **Jail (LOT):** Correctional officer and clothing lines to overtime (00:38:32). Passed unanimously (00:40:13).
- **Sheriff Addendum:** Deputy line to overtime (00:40:44). Passed by roll call vote after detailed administrative discussion regarding payroll versus claim procedures for employee settlements (00:47:11).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** All department transfer packages and the overarching financial/salary ordinance amendments were approved via roll call votes.
- 00:48:43 **Muncie Public Library Board Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Library representative / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appointment of Dr. Olin V. Dachshund (Interim Chair of Ball State University's College of Architecture and Planning) to fill a vacant seat on the 7-member library board following a member's passing.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved unanimously by roll call vote (00:50:40).
- 00:51:05 **Approval of 2022 Council Meeting Schedule**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adoption of the meeting calendar for the upcoming year, noting adjustments made to align with commissioner meetings and holidays.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved unanimously by roll call vote (00:51:37).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:52:13 **Sheriff Tony Skinner (Delaware County Sheriff)**

- Addressed the council regarding the ongoing severe staffing shortages within the sheriff's department. Noted that despite receiving pre-applications, low starting pay compared to surrounding municipal agencies continues to drive away qualified candidates and cause lateral transfers to competing departments.
 - **00:57:13 Zach Craig (Chief Deputy Prosecutor) & Chuck Zimmers**
 - Provided positive administrative updates regarding the creation of a new regional High-Tech Crime Unit hub housed in the prosecutor's office, funded by a \$285,000 annual state grant covering 11 counties. Chuck Zimmers will serve as the unit's director, working alongside local law enforcement agencies to extract digital evidence for major crimes.
 - **00:42:01 & 01:04:19 Captain Tony Johnson (Delaware County Sheriff's Office)**
 - Spoke during public comment regarding the retention crisis in law enforcement. Highlighted the recent departure of a 10-year veteran corporal who left for a neighboring county for a \$20,000 salary increase, emphasizing that uncompetitive pay structures leave the department operating well below full sworn staffing capacity.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
 - Election of 2022 Council Officers was conducted: **Scott Alexander** was elected Council President (**01:10:42**), and **Jessica Piper** was elected Vice President (**01:11:56**).
 - Members exchanged holiday greetings and well wishes for the new year.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion by Ballard and a second by Piper, approved unanimously by roll call vote (**01:17:33**).
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